

地域林業パートナー 牛峠工場 — Reference Sheet

Ushitoge Thinning-Timber Processing Center

Reference notes on the cooperative's sawmill/processing facility and its relevance to the biomass-CHP plan. Verified contact details vs. unconfirmed assumptions are kept separate on purpose.

Two sites, one cooperative

The 地域林業パートナー (Mitsue Village Forestry Cooperative, "Local Forestry Partner") operates from **two separate locations** in the village:

	Head office (本所)	Processing facility (牛峠工場)
District	菅野 / Sugano (central village)	神末 / Kōzue (up the valley)
Address	〒 633-1301 奈良県宇陀郡御杖村神末 797	奈良県宇陀郡御杖村神末 797
Tel	0745-95-2010	0745-95-2410
Role	Admin, membership, forestry planning	Sawmilling + timber processing
Coords	(central village)	~34.4890°N, 136.2060°E

The two sites are ~3–4 km apart (straight line); ~5–7 km by valley road. The office handles paperwork; the physical timber work happens at the Ushitoge (牛峠) site, which has the yard space and truck access.

Status: verified — head office address & phone confirmed via Mapion phonebook (2026-06-30); factory address & phone confirmed in project records.

Watch-outs

- **0745-95-2001 / 菅野368** is the **village hall 総務課** (municipal government), *not* the cooperative. Don't conflate.
- **[withheld] is dead / hijacked** — it now resolves to an unrelated page. There is no usable official coop website; use the 御杖村観光協会 (mitsue-kanko.jp) listing instead.

What the factory does (confirmed)

Processes thinning timber (間伐材) from forest management into marketable products: structural lumber, civil-engineering stakes, benches, wood blocks, and timber for public works — from local sugi (cedar) and hinoki (cypress).

Why it matters to the project: it is an **existing** processing site, so a biomass pilot can route thinnings here for chipping/drying instead of building new chip/dry capacity — those costs become per-m³ operating fees rather than capex. (Reflected in the forest-twin model as `transport_distance_km ≈ 6`, chipping/drying as fees.)

CHP relevance — confirmed vs. assumed

Confirmed: it is a wood-*processing* facility (lumber + products), not a dedicated biomass fuel plant. Facilities of this type generate residues (sawdust, slabs, offcuts, bark, low-grade logs) that are commonly chipped for fuel.

NOT confirmed (do not state as fact):

- Whether the factory currently has an industrial **chipper**.

- Whether it already produces **biomass fuel chips**.
- Annual throughput (m³/yr), lumber-vs-residue split, or volume of unused low-grade material.

Sizing reality check: our best literature benchmark (Mishima Town, Fukushima — NIES 2020, a simulation study, NIES confirmed by email 2026-09-07 no unit was ever built) models a village/forest of this type supporting a **≤50 kW_e CHP eating ~700–800 t/yr**. Any feasibility figure should cite this Mishima scenario (not as validated fact), not the larger "100 kW–1 MW" range floated in informal notes. (See

`degraded_forests_paper_summary_and_application.md`.)

Questions to ask the cooperative

Approach the **head office** (専務理事 / 森林整備担当 / 木材利用担当), not the factory directly. Open with resource, not requests:

1. How much residual wood do you generate per year after producing lumber?
2. How many m³ of thinning timber do you process annually? What % becomes lumber?
3. What happens to slabs, bark, and sawdust now?
4. Do you already produce biomass chips? If not, would you, given a local customer?
5. How much low-grade timber currently has little or no market value?

Cascading-use logic (target model)

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Forest → Thinning → 牛峠工場 ─┬─ Lumber (highest value)
                              │─ Construction timber
                              │─ Benches / stakes
                              └─ Residual wood → chipper → dry/store
                                   │
                                   │   → Biomass CHP / gasifier
                                   │   → Electricity + Heat
                                   │   → Village / EV charging / data cen
                                   │
                                   └─ (ash → soil amendment)
  
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High-quality logs to lumber, low-grade residues to energy — standard "cascading use." Extracts maximum value per tree before the remainder is burned for energy.

Sources

- Mapion phonebook — 地域林業パートナー:
<https://www.mapion.co.jp/phonebook/M16006/29386/22930070324/>
- 御杖村観光協会 (Mitsue Kanko) listing: <https://www.mitsue-kanko.jp/sightseeing/%E5%BE%A1%E6%9D%96%E6%9D%91%E6%A3%AE%E6%9E%97%E7%B5%84%E5%90%88/>
- Mishima/NIES anchor: `degraded_forests_paper_summary_and_application.md`